Technical Setup Guide

Hosted Platform Access and Compatibility Guide

Agent Failure Labs University Pilot Pack

Guide Summary

Agent Failure is a hosted, browser-based educational cyber range for AI agent security labs. Standard university pilot use does not require local Docker installation, university server deployment, student API keys, or command-line setup. Students access the platform through a web browser and complete labs in hosted, isolated lab sessions.

1. Purpose of This Guide

This guide is intended for instructors, teaching assistants, learning technology staff, and university IT support teams preparing to run Agent Failure Labs in a course or pilot.

It explains:

- how students and instructors access the hosted platform;
- what browser and network capabilities are required;
- what university IT teams may need to allowlist;
- what students need on their own devices;
- how hosted lab runtimes are provisioned;
- common access and troubleshooting issues.

This document is not a local installation manual. Agent Failure Labs are hosted by the platform provider for standard pilot use.

2. Deployment Model

2.1 Hosted Platform

Agent Failure is delivered as a hosted web application. Students and instructors access the platform through a browser.

2.2 No Local Student Runtime Required

Students do not need to install Docker, Python, Node.js, CUDA, virtual machines, security tools, or command-line packages to complete Lab 1.

All lab interactions occur through the browser, including:

- reading the mission briefing;
- sending attacker-controlled emails inside the lab;

Item	Pilot Model
Student access	Browser-based access to the hosted platform
Instructor access	Browser-based instructor/course interface
Local installation	Not required
Local Docker	Not required
Student API keys	Not required
University server deployment	Not required for standard pilots
Lab runtime	Provisioned and managed by Agent Failure
Authentication	Platform login, class code, or invite link depending on pilot configuration

- chatting with the AI assistant;
- viewing event timelines;
- inspecting trace-backed evidence;
- submitting or exporting report evidence, if enabled.

3. User Roles

3.1 Students

Students complete assigned labs through the hosted platform. They typically need:

- a supported browser;
- an internet connection;
- a course invitation, class code, or login credential;
- access to the student handout and assignment instructions.

3.2 Instructors

Instructors may use the platform to:

- create or access a course space;
- distribute a class code or lab link;
- monitor student progress;
- review attempts and traces;
- download or review submitted reports;
- export grades or completion data, if enabled.

3.3 Teaching Assistants

Teaching assistants may assist with:

- onboarding students;
- troubleshooting access issues;
- reviewing trace evidence;
- applying the grading rubric;
- escalating platform issues to the Agent Failure support contact.

4. Supported Access Flow

The expected access flow for a university pilot is:

1. Instructor receives or creates a course space.
2. Instructor distributes a class code, invite link, or access instructions.
3. Students log in or join the course.
4. Students open Lab 1.
5. Students read the pre-lab page.
6. Students start an isolated lab session.
7. Students complete the lab through the browser.
8. Students capture evidence and submit a report according to the course instructions.
9. Instructor reviews traces, reports, and completion status.

5. Student Device Requirements

6. Supported Browsers

The platform is intended to support modern evergreen browsers.

Pilot Recommendation

For the first university pilot, instructors should recommend Chrome, Chromium, or Edge on a laptop or desktop computer unless the platform has been tested with the institution's preferred browser.

7. Network Requirements

7.1 Required Network Access

At minimum, students need outbound HTTPS access to the hosted platform.

Requirement	Needed?	Notes
Laptop or desktop computer	Recommended	A full-size screen is recommended for viewing chat, inbox, and traces.
Tablet	Possible but not recommended	The lab may be difficult to complete on small screens.
Mobile phone	Not recommended	The interface is designed for desktop-style interaction.
Local Docker	No	Lab runtimes are hosted.
Local Python/Node.js	No	No local development environment is required.
Command-line access	No	Students interact through the browser UI.
Student-owned LLM API key	No	Students should not need their own model provider account.
Browser extensions	No	No extensions are required.

Browser	Status	Notes
Google Chrome / Chromium	Recommended	Preferred browser for pilots.
Microsoft Edge	Recommended	Chromium-based Edge should behave similarly to Chrome.
Mozilla Firefox	Supported if tested	Use a recent version. Some live trace behavior should be verified before class.
Safari	Supported if tested	Verify login, trace stream, and lab launch before a large class session.
Mobile browsers	Not recommended	UI may be constrained on small screens.

7.2 Domains to Allowlist

For a university pilot, IT teams may need to allowlist the relevant platform domains.

Deployment-Specific Values

Replace the placeholder domains below with the actual production domains before distributing this guide.

7.3 Third-Party Domains

If the platform uses third-party services for authentication, hosting, error monitoring, analytics, or LLM inference, those services may require additional network access.

Recommended Privacy-Preserving Configuration

For university pilots, LLM provider calls should be made server-side by the Agent Failure platform rather than directly from student browsers. Students should not need to supply API keys or communicate directly with model provider APIs.

Requirement	Needed?	Notes
Outbound HTTPS, TCP port 443	Yes	Required for platform access.
Inbound campus firewall changes	No	Students do not host services locally.
WebSockets or Server-Sent Events	Likely yes	Required if live trace or event updates use persistent browser connections.
Public internet access	Yes	Required to access the hosted platform.
VPN	Not normally required	May be used if required by the institution, but should be tested.
Student email access	Not required unless configured	Lab email is internal to the platform.

Domain	Required?	Purpose
`https://agentfailure.com`	Yes	Main platform access.
`https://app.agentfailure.com`	If used	Application frontend.
`https://api.agentfailure.com`	If used	Backend API requests.
`https://auth.agentfailure.com`	If used	Authentication provider or login flow.
`https://static.agentfailure.com`	If used	Static assets.
`https://status.agentfailure.com`	Optional	Platform status page, if available.

8. Authentication and Course Access

8.1 Possible Access Methods

Depending on the pilot configuration, students may access the platform through one of the following methods:

- individual student accounts;
- class code;
- instructor-provided invite link;
- temporary pilot credentials;
- university single sign-on, if supported in a later deployment.

8.2 Recommended Pilot Access Model

For early pilots, the recommended access model is:

1. Instructor receives a course invite link or class code.
2. Students create or access accounts using minimal identifiers.
3. Students join the assigned course or lab.
4. Instructor reviews progress and submissions from the course dashboard.

Service Type	Browser Access Needed?	Notes
Authentication provider	Possibly	Required only if login redirects through a third-party identity provider.
LLM API provider	Usually no	Ideally called server-side by Agent Failure, not directly from student browsers.
Error monitoring	Possibly	Only if browser-side error reporting is enabled.
Analytics	Optional	Should be disclosed in privacy documentation if used.
Cloud hosting/CDN	Possibly	Depends on deployment architecture.

8.3 SSO Status

University single sign-on may not be required for a small pilot. If SSO is required by the institution, confirm support before scheduling the lab.

SSO Question	Pilot Answer
Is SSO required for standard pilot use?	No, unless the institution requires it.
Can students use class codes or invite links?	Yes, if configured for the pilot.
Is SSO available?	To be confirmed for the specific deployment.
Should SSO be assumed?	No. Confirm before course adoption.

9. Runtime Provisioning

9.1 Hosted Lab Sessions

When a student starts Lab 1, the platform provisions or assigns a lab session for that student. The student interacts with the lab through the browser.

A lab session may include:

- an agent runtime;
- lab-specific state;
- a simulated email inbox;
- tool access configured for the lab;
- trace and event logging;
- success detection.

9.2 Isolation Model

For standard pilots, each student's lab attempt should be isolated from other students. One student's actions should not affect another student's lab state.

Isolation Area	Expected Behavior
Student lab state	Separate per student or per attempt.
Email inbox	Isolated to the student's lab session.
Agent runtime	Isolated or logically separated per session.
Trace data	Visible to student and instructor, not to other students.
Success status	Recorded per student or per attempt.
Reset behavior	Student or instructor can restart according to platform policy.

10. Data Flow Overview

The following is a simplified hosted-platform data flow.

1. Student opens the Agent Failure web application.
2. Browser communicates with the hosted platform over HTTPS.
3. Student starts a lab session.
4. Hosted platform provisions or assigns an isolated lab runtime.
5. Student sends emails and chat messages through the platform UI.
6. The agent runtime processes lab actions and tool calls.
7. Trace and event data are recorded for student review and instructor assessment.
8. Instructor reviews progress, traces, and reports through the platform.

11. Troubleshooting Guide

11.1 Student Cannot Access the Platform

Symptom	Student cannot load the platform website.
Possible Causes	Campus firewall block; DNS issue; browser issue; platform outage; incorrect URL.

Steps	1. Confirm the student is using the correct URL. 2. Ask the student to try Chrome or Edge. 3. Ask the student to try a different network, such as mobile hotspot, to isolate campus firewall issues. 4. Check whether other students are affected. 5. If multiple students are affected on campus Wi-Fi, contact campus IT with the allowlist requirements. 6. Check the platform status page, if available.

11.2 Login or Class Code Fails

Symptom	Student can access the site but cannot log in or join the course.
Possible Causes	Incorrect class code; expired invite; account mismatch; third-party auth issue; browser cookie restriction.
Steps	1. Confirm the class code or invite link. 2. Confirm whether the student is using the expected email/account. 3. Ask the student to try a private/incognito window. 4. Ask the student to clear site cookies if login loops occur. 5. Confirm that authentication domains are not blocked by campus network policy. 6. Escalate to platform support if the issue persists.

11.3 Lab Does Not Start

Symptom	Student clicks "Start Lab" but the lab remains loading or errors.
Possible Causes	Runtime provisioning issue; temporary capacity issue; browser connection problem; backend error.

Steps	1. Ask the student to refresh the page once. 2. Ask the student to return to the catalog and start the lab again. 3. Check whether other students are affected. 4. If only one student is affected, reset that student's session. 5. If many students are affected, pause the class activity and contact platform support.

11.4 Trace Stream or Event Timeline Does Not Update

Symptom	Student can use the lab, but trace or event updates do not appear.
Possible Causes	WebSocket/SSE blocked; event filters hiding data; browser issue; trace service delay.
Steps	1. Ask the student to check event filters. 2. Ask the student to refresh the trace panel. 3. Ask the student to try Chrome or Edge. 4. Confirm whether campus firewall permits persistent HTTPS connections such as WebSockets or Server-Sent Events. 5. If trace data remains unavailable, allow the student to capture alternative evidence and report the issue.

11.5 Email Does Not Appear in the Lab Inbox

Symptom	Student sends an email but cannot see it in the inbox or trace.
Possible Causes	Required fields missing; form not submitted; session mismatch; stale UI state; backend error.

Steps

1. Confirm the student entered sender, subject, and body fields if required.
2. Confirm the student clicked the correct submit/send button.
3. Ask the student to refresh the inbox panel.
4. Check the event timeline for an email-send event.
5. If no event appears, have the student resend the email.
6. If the issue persists, reset the lab session.

12. Recommended Pre-Pilot Test

Before assigning the lab to a class, the instructor or teaching assistant should run a complete test from a student perspective.

1. Open the student access URL.
2. Join the course or lab using the intended access method.
3. Start Lab 1.
4. Send a test email.
5. Ask the assistant to process the inbox.
6. Confirm that trace and event views update.
7. Confirm that the lab can be reset or restarted.
8. Confirm that instructor progress review works.
9. Confirm that report submission or export works, if enabled.

13. Support Information

For support requests, students or instructors should provide:

- course name or pilot identifier;
- lab name;
- student/session identifier, if available;
- approximate time of issue;
- browser and operating system;
- screenshot or error message;

- whether the issue affects one student or multiple students;
- whether the issue occurs on campus Wi-Fi, home network, or mobile hotspot.

Support Contact Placeholder

Support email: `support@agentfailure.com`
Security contact: `security@agentfailure.com`
Status page: `https://status.agentfailure.com`

14. Instructor Quick Reference

Question	**Answer**
Do students install anything?	No. The platform is browser-based.
Do students need Docker?	No. Lab runtimes are hosted.
Do students need API keys?	No.
Does the university need to host servers?	No, not for standard pilots.
What port is required?	Outbound HTTPS on TCP port 443.
Are WebSockets/SSE required?	Likely yes for live traces and event updates.
Do students attack real systems?	No. Labs use controlled, synthetic environments.
Can students use lab machines?	Yes, if browsers and network access are compatible.
What should IT allowlist?	Platform, API, authentication, and static asset domains as applicable.